

CORPORATE RISK ASSESSMENT

A practical 20-minute diagnostic for UAE business owners and management teams.

BLACKTHORNE & CHASE

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How to use this assessment

Answer each question honestly. A “no” does not automatically mean non-compliance; it is a signal that management should investigate the issue, confirm the applicable requirements and decide whether a control is needed.

1. Governance & Ownership

- YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Is there one person clearly accountable for compliance and risk?
- YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Are approval authorities and escalation thresholds documented?
- YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Does management receive a regular risk/compliance report?
- YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Are important risk decisions documented with an owner and due date?

2. Customers & Counterparties

- YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Do you know the beneficial owner of your key customers and suppliers?
- YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Do you risk-rate customers/counterparties rather than treating every relationship the same?
- YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Do you have an escalation process for unusual ownership, jurisdictions or transactions?
- YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Do you periodically refresh due diligence rather than collecting it once?

3. AML/CFT & Financial Crime

- YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Have you completed a business-specific AML/CFT risk assessment where applicable?
- YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Are KYC/CDD/EDD procedures documented and actually followed?
- YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Do staff know when and how to escalate a suspicious or high-risk situation?

■ YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Are compliance policies reviewed when the business, products or risks change?

4. Sanctions & International Exposure

■ YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Do you have a process for sanctions screening where relevant to your business?

■ YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Can you identify ownership/control issues behind counterparties?

■ YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Do you consider transaction route, goods/services and jurisdictions—not just the customer name?

■ YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Is there a documented escalation process for potential matches or concerns?

5. Operational Resilience

■ YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Have you identified the processes that would materially damage the business if interrupted?

■ YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Do you know which suppliers, banks, people and systems are critical dependencies?

■ YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Is there a practical continuity plan?

■ YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Has management tested or exercised the plan?

6. Management Visibility

■ YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Can the CEO or board see the company's top five risks in one page?

■ YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Does every material risk have an owner?

■ YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Are overdue remediation actions visible to management?

■ YES ■ NO ■ NOT SURE — Does the company revisit its risk profile when it enters a new market, product or relationship?

SCORING YOUR RESULTS

Count your “NO” and “NOT SURE” answers.

Result	What it suggests
0–4	Your framework may be reasonably mature. Focus on testing, documentation and continuous improvement.
5–9	You likely have material gaps worth prioritising. Start with the areas affecting banking, customers, counterparties
10+	Your business should consider a structured corporate risk and compliance assessment with an actionable remed

Want a second set of eyes?

Send the word RISK on WhatsApp to +971 58 523 7144. Blackthorne & Chase can arrange a confidential diagnostic conversation and, where appropriate, scope a fixed-fee corporate risk assessment.

WhatsApp: <https://wa.me/971585237144>

Important notice

This checklist is a management tool, not legal, tax, accounting, investment or financial advice. It is not a substitute for an assessment of the laws, regulations or supervisory requirements applicable to a particular business. Blackthorne & Chase operates as a UAE management consultancy and does not provide UAE legal advice or legal representation. Where regulated legal advice is required, appropriately licensed UAE counsel should be engaged.